

For the Chairperson Staffing An A.A. Exhibit

If you and your committee have agreed to staff a booth at a national conference you may find the information below helpful. There is also a section in the C.P.C. Workbook (page 22) on Exhibits that you may want to review. In addition, feel free to contact the C.P.C. Coordinator and the Coordinator of Exhibits using the information below.

As you may know, exhibiting fees will be paid in advance by the General Service Office (G.S.O.). This includes expenses for booth furniture. On-site changes to furniture orders can be expensive so if you have a special request please discuss it with the C.P.C. Coordinator at G.S.O. in advance.

Many conferences now offer new ways to capture the contact information of those visiting a booth. Often called Badge-Reader Technology or Lead Retrieval, it can make following up with professionals much more efficient. Sometimes it's an app you can download to your phone, other times a simple device you can use to scan badges. Event personnel are usually available to offer technical assistance. The C.P.C. Coordinator may ask if you are comfortable trying it, and if you are then G.S.O. will pay the fee for that as well.

Here's what you will receive from G.S.O. and when you will receive it:

- 3 months or so before the event you'll receive a letter with the event dates, the location, information for volunteers, and a form showing you what literature you will be receiving for the booth. If you have any questions or suggestions about literature please call or email the C.P.C. Coordinator (see the information below.)
- 2 months or so before the event (depending on when the conference planners send us the information) you will receive a floor plan showing you where the booth will be located as well as the exhibit hours. You'll also receive the C.P.C. evaluation form with return envelope, and an estimated date of arrival for the literature.
- 20-30 days before the event the literature will arrive. It's always a good idea to inventory the literature so if something is missing we can get it to you in time. A smaller box of Grapevine items may arrive separately as this sometimes has to be shipped from a different location. We're finding that Grapevine items are popular with professionals, especially when they relate to the focus of the conference (for example the issue on "A.A. in the Workplace" or "A.A. in the Military.")
- 10 days or so before the event you will receive the display materials: one table-throw, and one banner stand (a second banner will be included if many French or Spanish speakers will be attending the event.) Federal Express 2-Day Air Economy labels will be enclosed to make it easy for you to return the display materials as soon as the booth closes. *Make sure you hang onto the return Fed-Ex shipping labels.*

We ship materials directly to you rather than to the event for two reasons: so you get them in advance and can familiarize yourself with them; and because it is much more expensive to ship them directly to the conference. Since we have a modest set-up, the vast majority of event planners won't mind if you hand-carry materials to the booth or use a small cart. If they do object to hand-carrying materials please contact us right away using the information below.

Prior to the event:

You may wish to obtain local A.A. meeting lists to have at the booth. These are especially helpful for travelling A.A. members who may wish to attend a local meeting.

You may want to inquire about parking. It can be costly but discounts are sometimes available through the conference. Unfortunately, G.S.O. is not able to reimburse individuals or committees for the cost of parking.

Meet with your volunteers to review the set-up and break-down times as well as exhibit hours. Experience suggests it is good to schedule volunteers on a half-day basis. Badges can be shared and will most likely say "A.A. Volunteer" on them. Make sure your volunteers are familiar with the suggestions in "For Volunteers Staffing an A.A. Exhibit."

During the event:

It's very important to make sure the booth is staffed whenever the exhibit hall is open.

Lead by example when it comes to warmly greeting attendees. Some chairs have found that having a bowl of candy is a good ice-breaker.

Professionals may not want to take the time to fill out a P.I. label or *About A.A.* card. You can always fill it in yourself from their business card or create a simple sign-up sheet for email addresses and optional phone numbers. Badge readers make getting contact information easy — but always ask permission before scanning their badge.

At the close of the event:

Please return the banner display and table throw *immediately*, using the Federal Express return labels enclosed in the lid of the display case and inside the table throw box. If you cannot find the pre-paid labels please call us. *Do not* ship the materials using any other shipper as the cost may be significantly higher. The committee should keep any leftover literature rather than shipping it back to us.

Please use the return envelope to send the *About A.A.* subscription cards, and the blue & white PI labels to the C.P.C. Coordinator (if you use a badge reader the information will be uploaded automatically). Also, please enclose your completed evaluation form. Your comments and suggestions are very valuable, so thank you for taking the time to fill out the evaluation! We appreciate you sharing your experience with us!

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